fish stocks in American waters were overfished in 2015, down from 25 percent in 2000. However, the quota system can encourage fishermen to take the largest fish possible, and to throw back smaller fish, which frequently die from the stress of being caught. In many cases, quotas are also not set at a truly sustainable limit; commercial fishermen often have considerable lobbying power, and focus on the short-term economic gains of catching more fish rather than on long-term sustainability. Fishery management can be further complicated by factors such as the open access nature of the ocean, illegal fishing, and an absence of regulation and oversight.